

DeskPRO Helpdesk Software: Agent Interface Quick Start Guide

The DeskPRO helpdesk platform is designed to make it easy to handle problems and questions from your users. Your helpdesk ties together all the information about each issue into a single **ticket**. Managing these tickets via the Tickets app forms the basis of your organization's helpdesk.

DeskPRO includes other apps to help you manage communication with your users, including live chat, user feedback, CRM, tasks and publishing help content.

You should have an email called *"Your new DeskPRO helpdesk agent account"* with your login details.

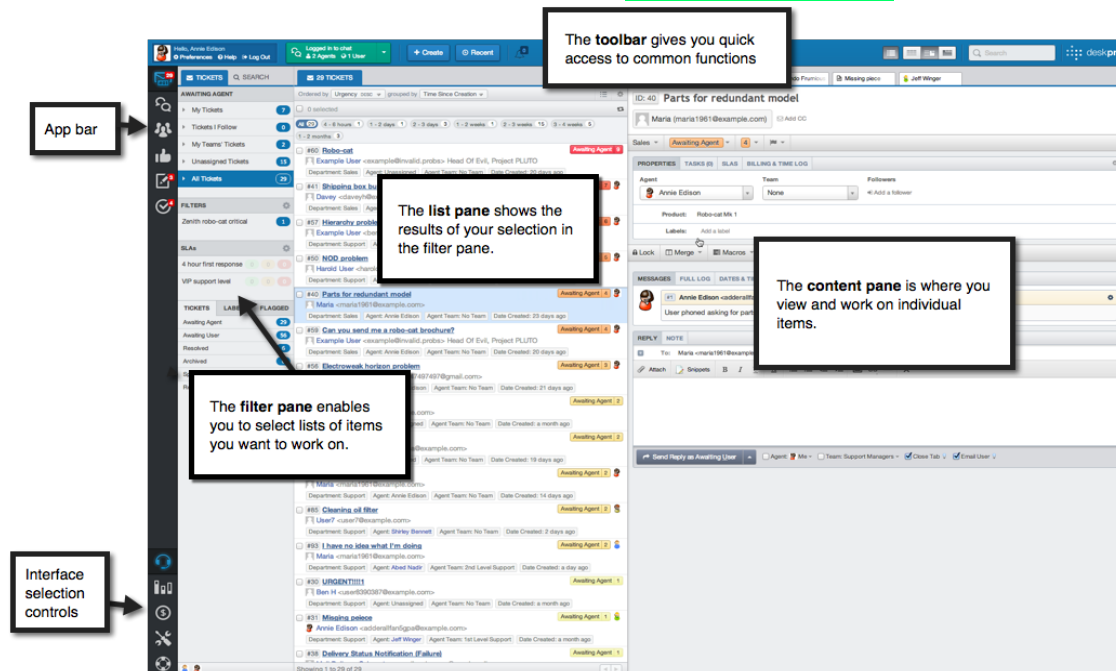
Account types within DeskPRO

users: the people you are helping; if you're using DeskPRO for customer support, this will be your customers; for an internal helpdesk, this will be your organization's staff.

agents: you and other staff within your organization who use DeskPRO to provide help to your users.

admins: agents who have administrator access to configure your helpdesk.

[1-interface-overview.png](#)



After you log in, you'll see the **agent** interface below.

At the top is the **toolbar**:

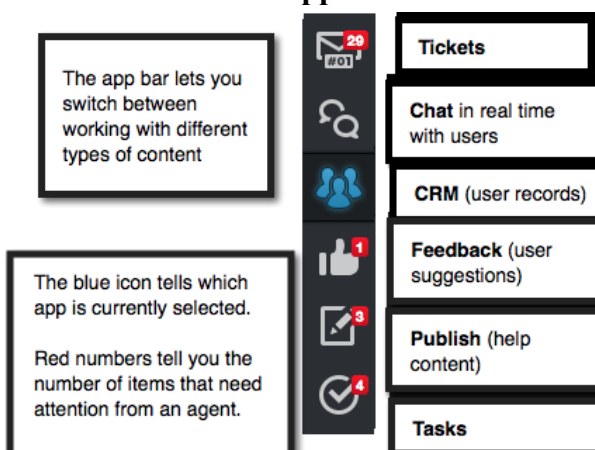
[1-toolbar.png](#)

[1-app-bar.png](#)

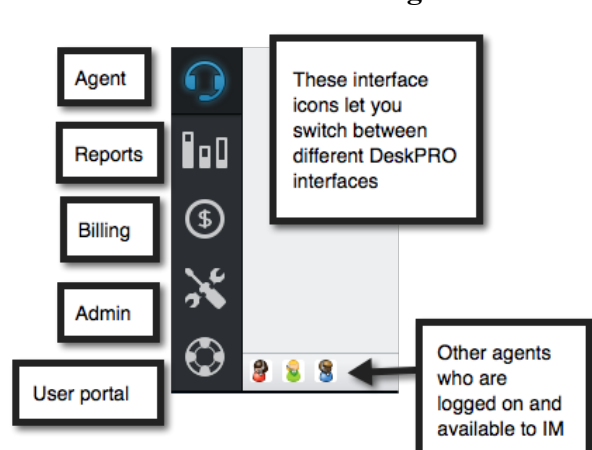
[1-interface-icons.png](#)



App bar



Interface switching





The Tickets App

Finding tickets

The filter pane is where you select a list of tickets to work on.

Advanced search for tickets (points to the search bar)

Tickets awaiting agent need attention (points to the 'All Tickets' button)

Custom filters (points to the 'Filters' section)

Shows if tickets are passing or failing your Service Level Agreements (points to the SLAs section)

All tickets by status (points to the 'Tickets' section)

TICKETS	
AWAITING AGENT	
My Tickets	10
Tickets I Follow	0
My Teams' Tickets	2
Unassigned Tickets	12
All Tickets	29

FILTERS	
Critical tickets from Acme	2
Sales dept & older than 5 days	11

SLAs	
4 hour first response	2 (green) 0 (yellow) 2 (red)
VIP support level	0 (green) 5 (yellow) 0 (red)

TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
Awaiting Agent		29
Awaiting User		60
Resolved		6
Archived		0
Spam		3
Recycle Bin		2

Ticket status

Each ticket has a **status**, which indicates who needs to act on the ticket next.

Awaiting Agent - An agent needs to perform the next action on the ticket; this will usually involve replying to the user.

Awaiting User - You're waiting for the user to contact your helpdesk, typically to provide more information about their issue.

Resolved - The issue is resolved and communication has ended. Resolved tickets can be re-opened if needed.

Agent assignment

Tickets start out unassigned but can be assigned to an agent and/or a team.

My Tickets shows tickets that are assigned to you.

My Teams' Tickets shows tickets that are assigned to any team which you're a member of.

Tickets I Follow is a way to keep track of tickets that you're not directly assigned to, but you are still monitoring.

Unassigned tickets are neither assigned to a team nor to an agent.

2-tickets-filterpane.png

You can group tickets with “**Awaiting Agent**” status by a number of fields, for example to find tickets assigned to each of the agents in your team.

2-grouping1-3.png

Click any of the small arrows to filter by custom groups (points to the small arrows in the filter pane)

Select Field to Group Tickets (points to the dropdown menu)

Agent (points to the selected field)

TICKETS	
AWAITING AGENT	
My Tickets	3
Tickets I Follow	1
My Teams' Tickets	12
Unassigned Tickets	4
All Tickets	13

TICKETS	
AWAITING AGENT	
My Tickets	3
Tickets I Follow	1
My Teams' Tickets	12
Unassigned	4
Acme IT Boss	3
Acme Support Agent 1	4
Acme Support Agent 2	1
Unassigned Tickets	4
All Tickets	13

Tickets in the list pane

The tickets which match the criteria you select in the filter pane are then shown in the list pane.

Click a ticket to open it in the content pane. A ticket that is open in the content pane is highlighted in blue.

The screenshot shows a list of tickets with annotations:

- Subject**: Points to the ticket subject line.
- User**: Points to the user information.
- Change how tickets are ordered: currently in descending order of urgency**: Points to the 'Ordered by' dropdown.
- Change the information displayed for tickets in list**: Points to the list view icon.
- Urgency is 9**: Points to the urgency score.
- Ticket is close to failing an SLA (amber) or has failed (red)**: Points to the SLA status indicator.
- Ticket is open in content pane (blue highlight)**: Points to the highlighted ticket.

Urgency is a score from 1 to 10 – where 10 is most urgent. It can be changed by agents or by automatic rules set up by your DeskPRO administrators. It is designed to help you prioritize tickets.

3-urgencies.png

An **SLA** is a condition to meet (such as replying to a new ticket within 4 hours). When a ticket is close to failing an SLA, it is marked amber; when it fails, it is marked red. **3-slans.png**

SLAs			
First Response	1	1	7
Total wait < 3 days	5	0	5

3-ticketslist.png

You can select multiple tickets with checkboxes. This is useful if you need to apply the same action to multiple tickets – for example, assigning several tickets to an agent, mass replying or bulk deleting.

The screenshot shows a list of tickets with 3 selected. The 'Apply actions to 3 selections' panel is open, showing options to change status, assign agent/team, add followers, and mass reply.

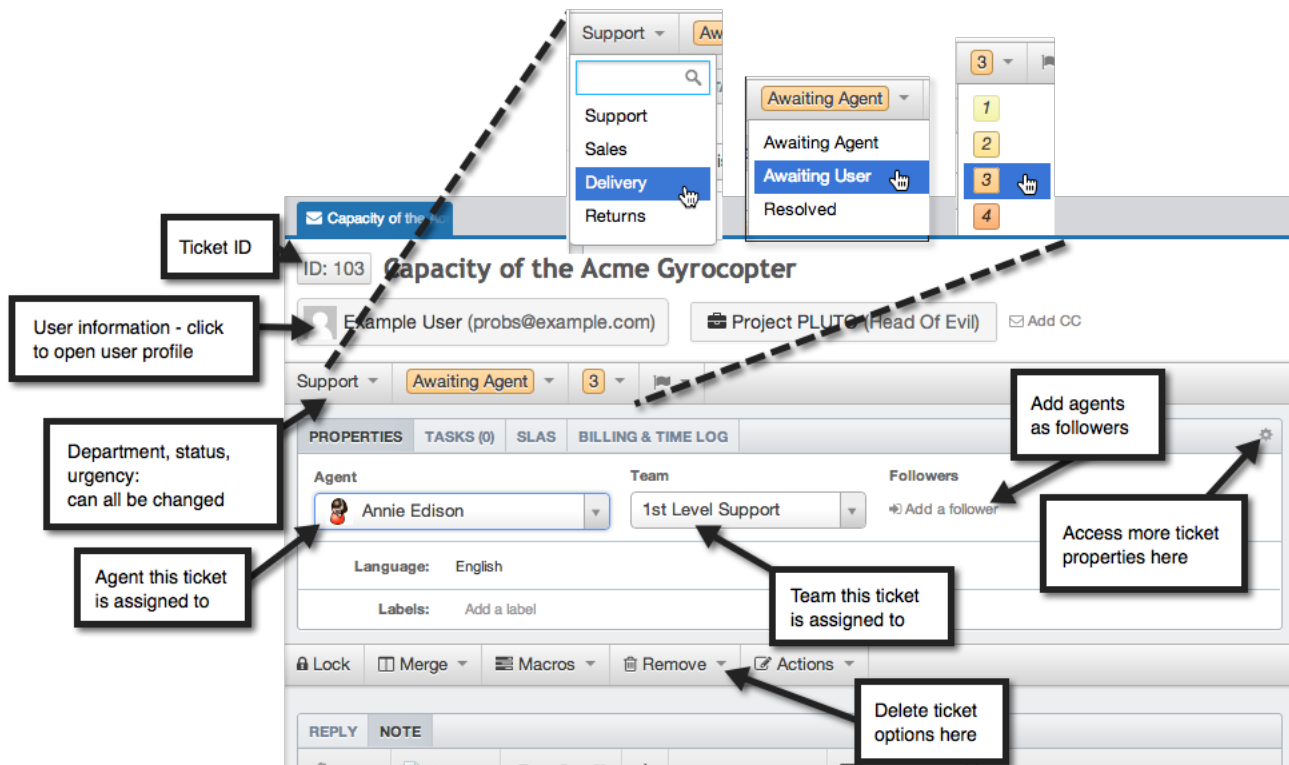
3-massaction.png

You can group tickets in the list pane. If you've grouped tickets in the filter pane in one way, this allows you to subgroup them: for example, tickets assigned to a specific agent, grouped by the department.

The screenshot shows the 'grouped by' dropdown menu with options: None, Department, Product, and Organization. The resulting grouped tickets are shown in the list pane.

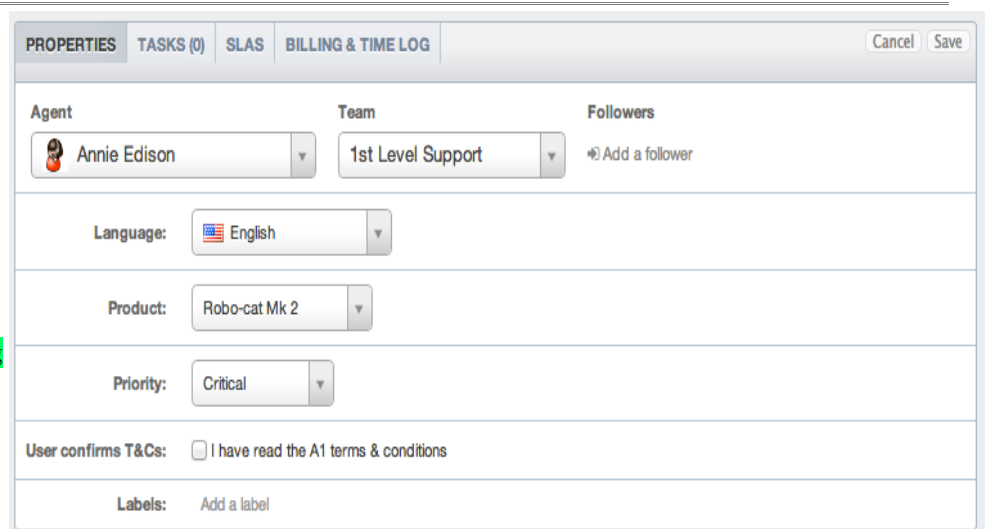
3-grouping-in-listpane.png

Anatomy of a ticket [4-ticket-full.png](#), [4-selecting-dept status urgency.png](#)



The cog in the top right of the ticket's **Properties** tab lets you access additional ticket fields.

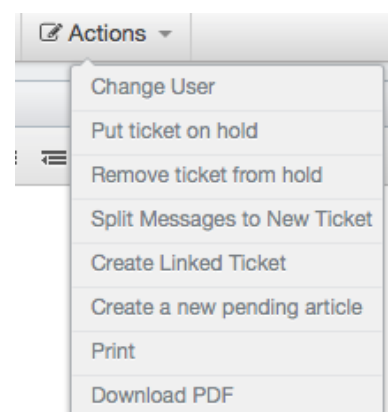
What you see here will be determined by how your administrators have configured your helpdesk. [5-properties.png](#)



The **Actions** pull-down menu above the reply box offers advanced functions:

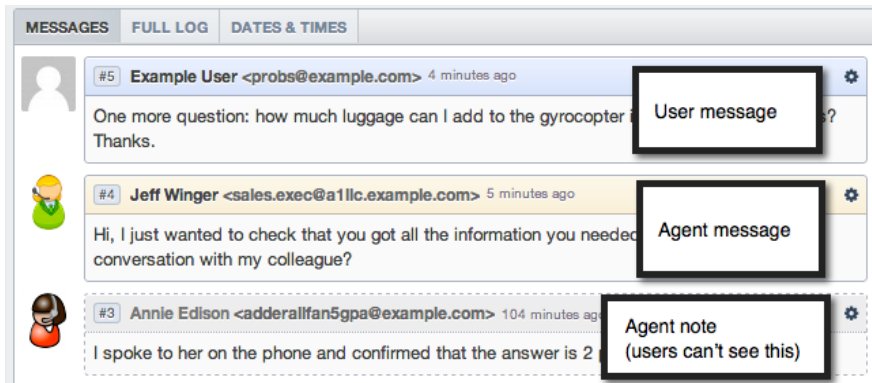
You can put a ticket on **hold** status – this is useful if the user is awaiting a reply, you are waiting for something else to happen (for example, hearing back from a third party) before you can answer.

Create a new pending article is a way to note that a knowledgebase article should be created based on the ticket. [5-actionsmenu.png](#)



but

Ticket messages 4-messages.png



By default, messages are displayed with the newest message first and the reply box at the top.

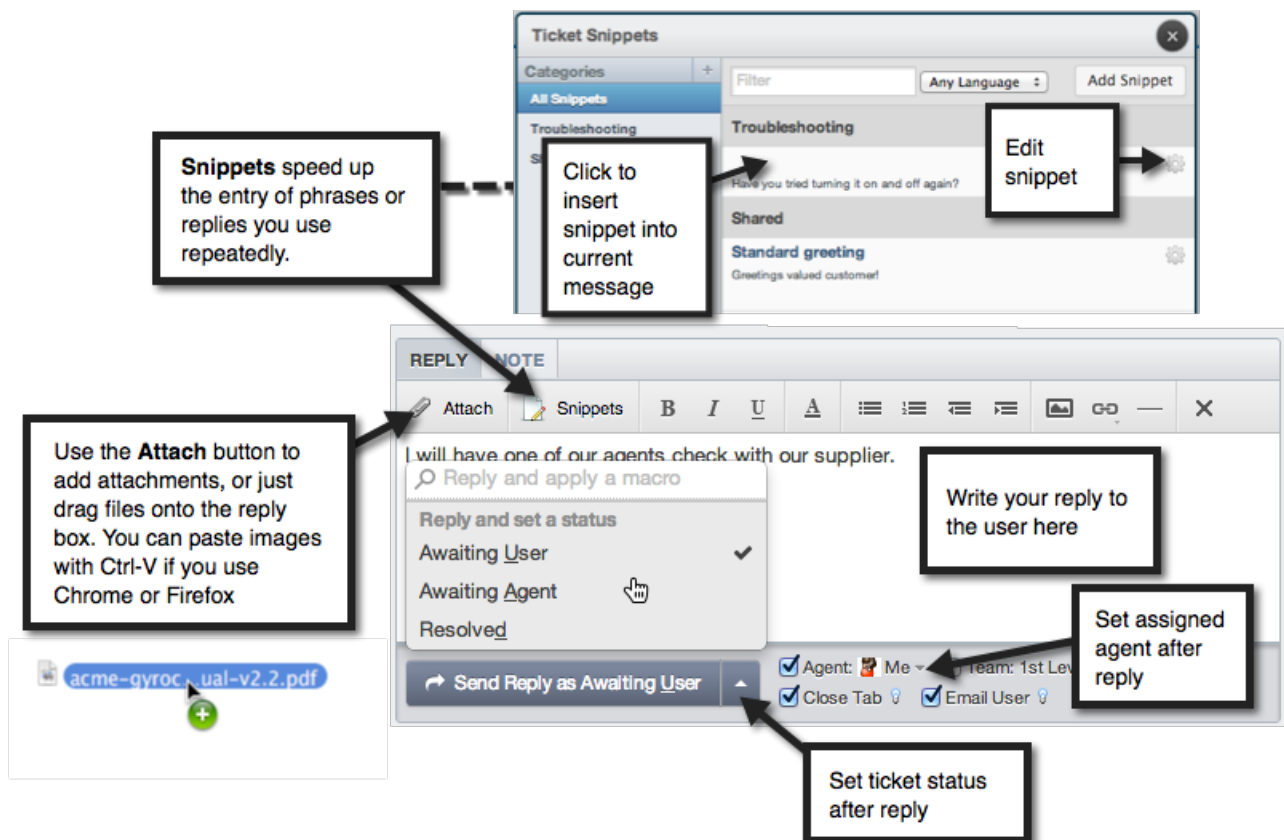
You can use **Preferences** to switch to displaying the oldest message first, with the reply box at the bottom.

Replying to a ticket

When you reply to a ticket, by default the ticket is assigned to you, your reply is emailed to the user, and the ticket status is set to “awaiting user”.

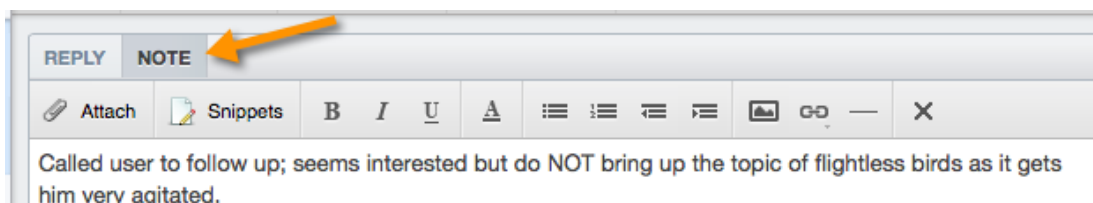
In some situations, you'll want to keep the status as **awaiting agent** or mark the ticket as **resolved** after you reply.

You can also change the assigned agent. 5-snippets-ui.png 4-dragndrop.png 4-replying.png



You can write a **note** which is visible only to other agents, but not to the user. Just click on the **Note** tab.

5-note.png

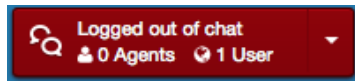




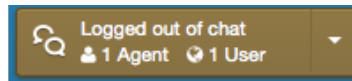
The Chat App

Users can initiate a real-time chat conversation from your web portal or website.

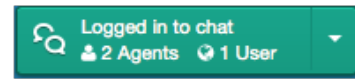
You can sign in and out of the chat system using the pull-down menu in the toolbar.



No agents logged in;
chat is disabled



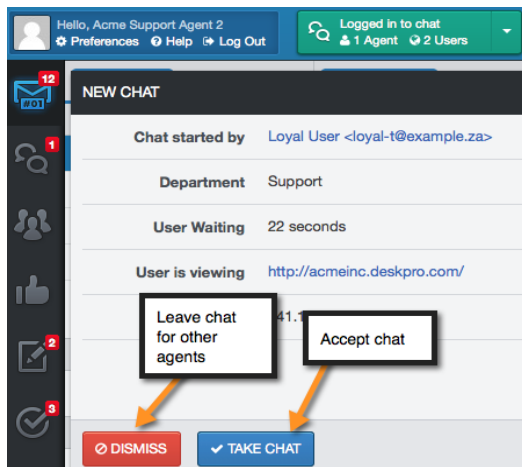
You are logged out,
but other agents are
logged in



You are logged in
to chat

6-chatred 6chatbrown 6chatgreen.png

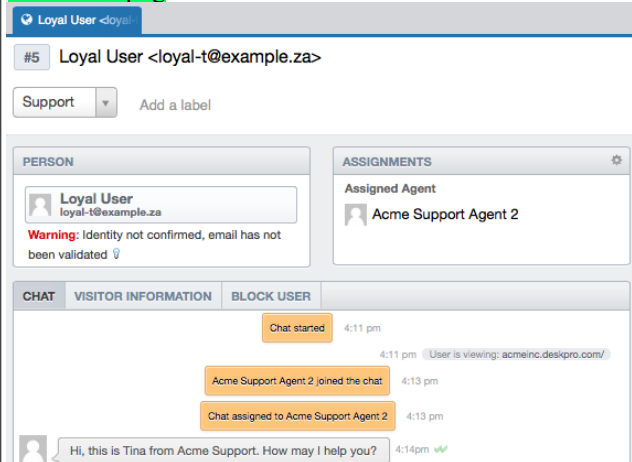
When a user initiates a chat, you will see a **New Chat** notification at the upper left of the interface.



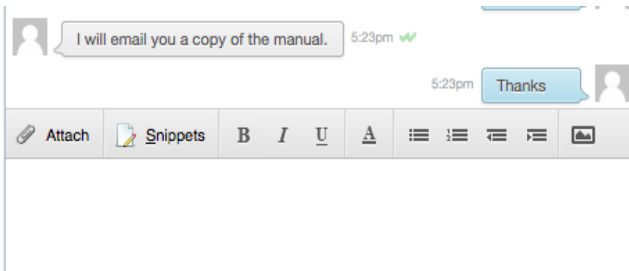
6-newchat.png

If you accept the chat, it opens in the content pane.

6-takechat.png



Chatting works much like any instant messaging service.

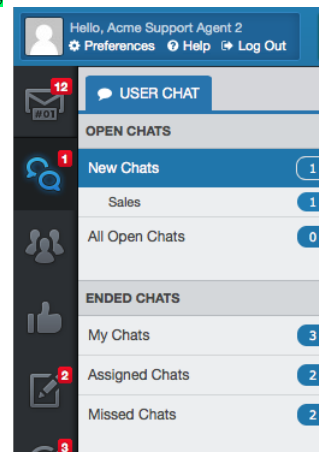


6-chatformat.png

You can format your messages, send attachments and use snippets just as you do when replying to a ticket.

You can use the Chat app to accept open chats, or view missed chats and the content of closed chat sessions.

6-chatapp.png



Creating a linked ticket from a chat

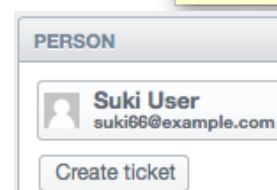
Use this button while chatting to create a ticket linked to the chat. This is particularly useful if an issue raised in chat needs to be followed up.

6-chat-maketicket.png



You can also create a linked ticket from a closed or missed chat:

6-chattixold.png





The CRM App

The DeskPRO CRM app helps you keep track of your users.

You can see detailed user information by clicking on a user's name in various places:

7-user-chat list ticket

7-user-record.png

The diagram illustrates three different ways to access detailed user information in the CRM app:

- Ticket:** Clicking on a user's name in a ticket list (e.g., "Brian Canid (coyote@example.com)") leads to the user record.
- List pane:** Clicking on a user's name in the list pane (e.g., "Brian Canid (CTO, DreadCo)") leads to the user record.
- Chat:** Clicking on a user's name in the chat pane (e.g., "Brian Canid (coyote@example.com)") leads to the user record.

The detailed user record for Brian Canid shows various tabs and sections:

- Summary:** User name, email, and a "Create Ticket" button.
- Properties:** Timezone (UTC (GMT +0)), Local Time (Thur, 13th Mar 2014 10:19am).
- Tickets:** A list of tickets, including "Warranty terms" with a status of "Awaiting Agent".
- Chats:** A list of chats.
- Notes:** A section for adding new notes.
- Activity Stream:** A section for viewing activity.
- Detail:** A section for viewing detailed information.
- Contact Information:** Email (coyote@example.com) and a "Download vCard" button.
- Organization:** CTO, Manager, DreadCo, with a link to "14 members".
- Usergroups:** Registered.

Users can belong to organizations and usergroups. Edit them with these cogs.

The diagram shows how usergroups and organizations are managed in the CRM app:

- Usergroups:** A list of usergroups is shown, including "VIPs" (3 members). The "VIPs" usergroup is highlighted, and a note states: "Usergroups affect what the user can do with tickets, chat and web portal content – your administrator decides the settings."
- Organizations:** A list of organizations is shown, including "DreadCo" (14 members), "DHARMA" (2 members), "Ace Tomato" (2 members), and "Universal Products" (1 member). A note states: "Organizations track who the user works for. DeskPRO can automatically assign users to an organization based on their email addresses."

7-crm-filter, 7-organizations, 7-vip

Open an organization in the content pane to access more functions: 7-org-functions.png

The diagram shows the functions available when an organization is open in the CRM app:

- Members:** A list of members, including "Brian Canid" (CTO), "Susan Expert" (Senior IT Tech), and "Horatio Gentlem" (Doorman).
- Tickets:** A list of tickets.
- Chats:** A list of chats.
- Email Domain:** A section for managing email domains, with a note: "Users with emails at these domains will be automatically associated with this organization. example.com".
- Usergroups:** A section for managing usergroups, with a note: "Add everyone in the company to a certain usergroup".

Click this flag to make user a manager - they can now see all tickets for the organization.



The Feedback App

Users can submit feedback, such as ideas for new products or suggestions for how to improve your services, through your web portal. Other users can vote on this feedback, enabling you to crowdsource the most popular ideas. [8-feedback-userui.png](#)

The screenshot shows the Feedback App interface. At the top, a form labeled "I have a..." allows users to submit feedback, with a dropdown menu showing "Suggestion", "Feature Request", and "Bug Report". A callout box states: "Feedback types are set by your administrator". A "Go" button is on the right. Below the form, a table lists feedback items. A callout box on the left says: "You may need to approve feedback and comments before they are shown on the portal." The table has columns for "STATUS", "TYPE", and "LABELS". The "STATUS" column lists "New", "Active", "Planning", "Started", "Under Review", "Archived", "Completed", "Duplicate", and "Declined". The "TYPE" column lists "Suggestion", "Feature Request", and "Bug Report". The "LABELS" column shows the number of items for each status and type. A callout box on the right says: "Filter feedback by type". Below the table, a list of feedback items is shown, each with a title, type, and date created. A callout box points to the "Number of votes for each item" column.

Feedback types are set by your administrator

Filter feedback by type

You may need to approve feedback and comments before they are shown on the portal.

Number of votes for each item

The **status** of feedback lets you track how your company is going to deal with each item.

You can change the status by opening an item of feedback in the content pane, or with mass actions in the filter pane.

Active statuses mean that your company is acting on the feedback, or at least considering it.

Archived statuses mean that the feedback has been dealt with, either acted on or rejected.

[8-feedback-details](#)

The screenshot shows the details view for a feedback item titled "Integrate your robot horse and jetpack products for bigger jumps". The item is a "Suggestion" and has 5 votes. The user "Jethro Vortex (user@example.com)" is the creator. The item is currently in the "New" status. A dropdown menu is open, showing the following status options: "New", "Active", "Planning", "Started", "Under Review", "Archived", "Completed", and "Duplicate". The "Started" status is currently selected. The item has a description: "Why can't I buy a jetpack for my horse? Seems like a no-brainer."

Integrate your robot horse and jetpack products for bigger jumps

Type: Suggestion

5 votes (+1)

Jethro Vortex (user@example.com)

Aviation

Delete Mark as spam Merge

permalink View in user interface

ITEMS (1) REVISIONS (0) RELATED CONTENT (0)

SEARCH

Edit

Why can't I buy a jetpack for my horse? Seems like a no-brainer.

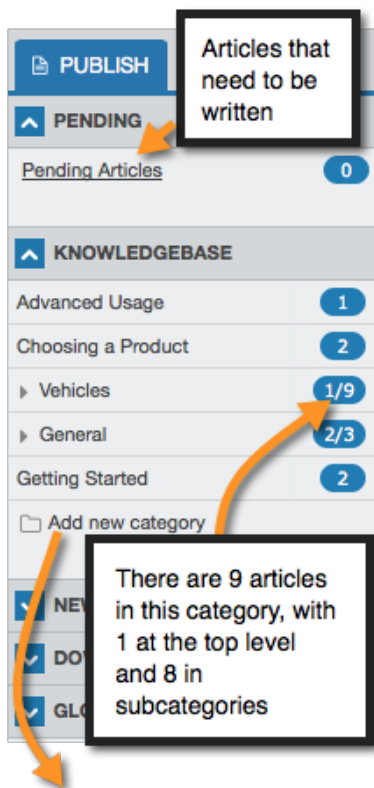


The Publish App

The Publish app is where you manage the content available on your web portal.

- **Knowledgebase** articles are used for help or how-to information. You can organize them into categories. Articles are formatted with rich text, and can include images and attachments. You can quickly create an article based on a ticket to help other users with the same problem.
- **News** posts are designed for announcements. They're displayed on the portal with the most recent post first, like blog entries.
- **Downloads** are files you want to make available to your users (such as electronic manuals, product brochures, or software).
- **Glossary** items are terms you want to define for users, for example because they're technical jargon or product names. When a glossary term first appears in a knowledgebase article, users can mouse over it to see the definition.

Knowledgebase



Add Category

PROPERTIES

Title: Secret codes

Parent Category: Advanced Usage

Permissions:

- ☐ Everyone
- ☐ Registered
- ☒ Power Users
- ☐ Trial Users
- ☒ VIPs

[9-kb-addcat.png](#) You can choose to make a category visible only to members of certain usergroups. In this example, all content within the "Secret Codes" category will be visible only to users from the "Power Users" and "VIPs" usergroups.

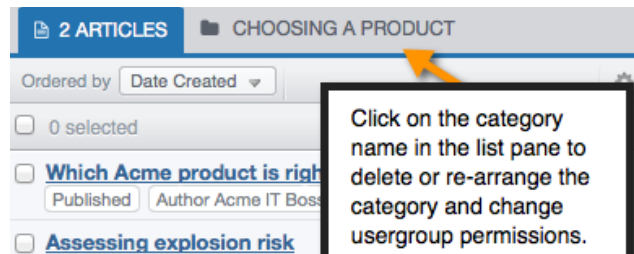
If you are viewing a ticket and decide that an article should be created to explain the problem, you can use the [9-actions-button.png](#) button to create a **pending article** linked to that ticket.

[9-actions-button.png](#)

To create a new article from scratch, use the **Create** button in the toolbar [9-createbutton.png](#)



[9-kb-catedit.png](#) [catedit2.png](#)



DELETE CATEGORY

Delete Category

EDIT CATEGORY

Title: Choosing a Product

Permissions:

- ☒ Everyone
- ☒ Registered
- ☒ Power Users
- ☒ Trial Users
- ☒ VIPs

REORDER CATEGORY (DRAG & DROP)

Advanced Usage

Choosing a Product

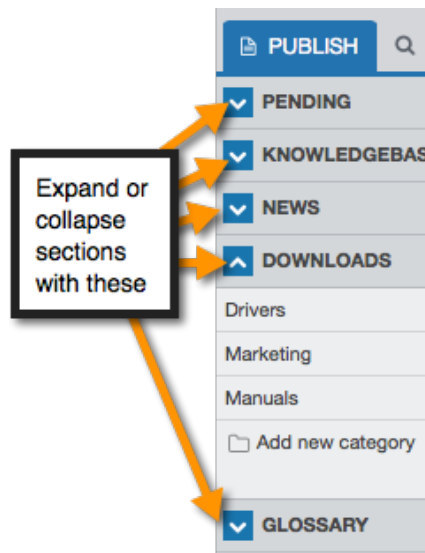
► Vehicles

By default, a new article will be published on creation. If it's not ready yet, you can set its status as **Draft** – so it goes to the Pending section – or **Unpublished**.

Open an article in the content pane to change its status or category. An article that has been published can be set to **Archived** if it is out of date.

In the **Properties** tab of an article, you can set an automatic unpublish date. This is useful to make sure you review articles regularly or to remove aged content.

News and Downloads



Creating News and Downloads and arranging them into categories works a lot like creating Knowledgebase articles.

News posts are displayed on the portal in reverse chronological order.

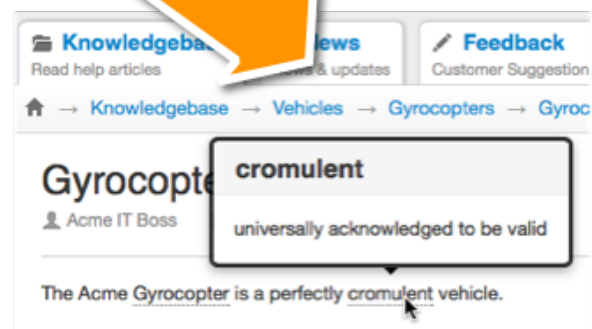
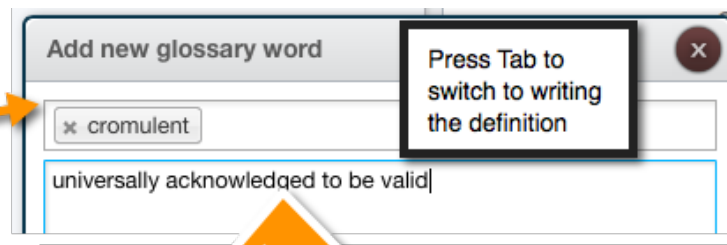
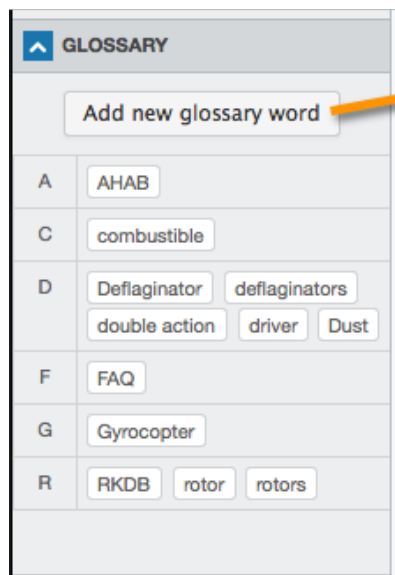
A Download is a single file with a description. You can use downloads to offer manuals, brochures, software drivers etc.

10-downloads.png

Glossary

When you add a glossary word, it will be defined for users the first time it appears in a Knowledgebase article.

10-define.png



10-glossary.png

10-glossary-popup.png



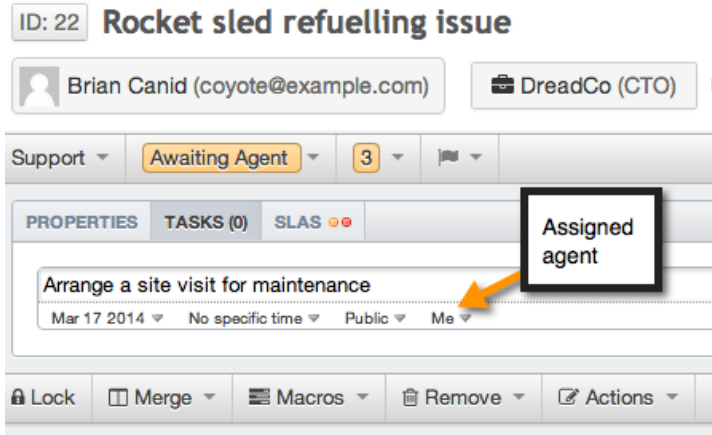
The Tasks App

The Tasks app allows you to track and assign agent tasks.

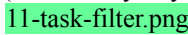
You can create a task from the  button in the toolbar.

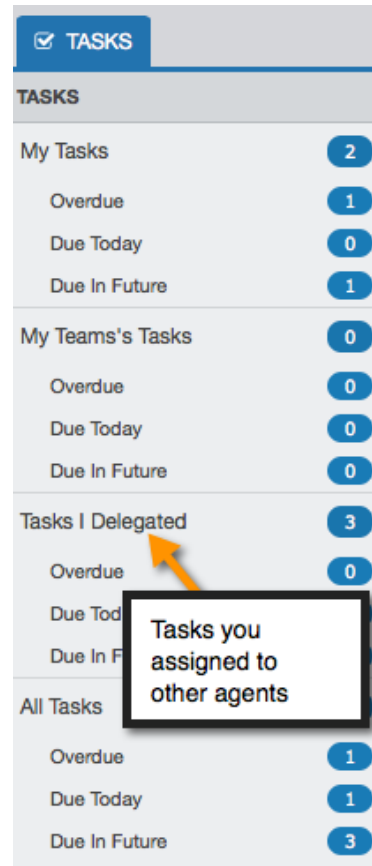
You can also create a task from a ticket:





By default, a task you create is assigned to you, but you can assign it to other agents.

Tasks can either be **Public** (visible to all) or **Private** (visible only to you and the agent assigned the task). 



Learning more about DeskPRO

We hope you found this quick overview of the DeskPRO agent interface useful. We designed the agent interface to let you work as quickly and efficiently as possible; there are a lot more features and options for power users than we could show you here.

For an in-depth guide to using DeskPRO as an **agent**, read the [DeskPRO Agent Manual](#), available as a PDF from the Downloads section of [support.deskpro.com](#).

If you need to set up and configure a DeskPRO helpdesk as an **admin**, we recommend you read the [DeskPRO Admin Manual](#), which is available from the same place.

Our Support Center at [support.deskpro.com](#) also has an extensive collection of articles which cover topics beyond the scope of the manuals, like troubleshooting specific problems, and advanced topics like the DeskPRO API.

If you run into a problem that you can't resolve with the resources above or by asking your admins, please email us at support@deskpro.com.

DeskPRO Terms

Admin: staff member within your organization who has administrator access to configure and customize your helpdesk.

Agent: staff member within your organization who uses DeskPRO to provide help.

Article: in the context of DeskPRO, an article refers to a **Knowledgebase** article

Assignment: a ticket can be assigned to an agent or a team (or both) to specify who is responsible for that ticket.

CC: a user who is CCed on a ticket will receive notifications about its progress. The equivalent for agents is **following**.

Chat: real-time text messaging between agents and users; may be available to users from the web portal or integrated into a website.

CRM: the app used for managing users and assigning them to **organizations** and **usergroups**; short for **Customer Relationship Management**.

Downloads: files you provide to users through your web portal; e.g., software drivers or product manuals; maintained in the **Publish** app.

Feedback: crowdsourced suggestions from users submitted through your **web portal**; e.g. a feature request or new product idea.

Following: an agent added as a follower of a ticket can get notifications and see it in the **Tickets I Follow** filter; useful for keeping track of a ticket without being assigned to it.

Glossary: part of the **Publish** app used to maintain definitions of terms which are automatically displayed in **knowledgebase** articles.

Knowledgebase: part of the **web portal** which contains help **articles**

News: part of the **web portal** which displays news posts chronologically

Organizations: used to track the company or other enterprise a user belongs to; you can assign users to organizations using the **CRM** app, or DeskPRO can automatically assign users to an organization based on email address.

Permissions: settings which control what an agent or user can do with DeskPRO; your agent permissions are set by your admins and might, for example, prevent you deleting tickets; a user's permissions depend on their **usergroup**

Publish: the app used to maintain content for the web portal: Knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads and glossary entries

SLAs: short for Service Level Agreements; goals for dealing with tickets that your helpdesk aims to meet, e.g. that you must reply to a new ticket within 4 hours; shown in the **Tickets** app.

Snippets: short pieces of text which you can quickly insert into messages to users; useful to save time entering standard greetings, phrases, "canned answers" etc.

Status: used to track who needs to act on a ticket next: **awaiting agent** means the helpdesk must do something related to that ticket; **awaiting user** means the helpdesk is waiting for the user to reply; **resolved** means the issue that ticket represents has been resolved.

Tasks: an app used to track "to-do" items for agents.

Teams: agents are grouped into teams to enable group ticket assignment.

Ticket: represents a user question, problem or complaint; can be created automatically from incoming user email, or by a user from the **web portal**, or by an agent on a user's behalf.

User: one of the people the helpdesk is trying to help.

Usergroup: users belong to usergroups which determine what they are allowed to do and see when interacting with DeskPRO; created by admins, assigned with the **CRM** app.

Web portal: the user-facing web interface of DeskPRO – can be integrated into your own website; help information on the portal is maintained using the **Publish** app.